The Mountainside

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Annual Meeting: New Board, New Capital Improvements

Two new board members were elected – and one was re-elected at the Annual Meeting held at Treetops on July 22nd. Richard Kaufman was re-elected to his board seat, and subsequently was elected President of the Association by the new board following the meeting. The two new board members are Joan Hash and Lon Dring.

The 2000 Annual meeting also delivered a new bathroom and changing facility for the swimming pool, and a new office for CMA's Operations Manager and our vitally important records. Members approved the 2000 budget of total $76,160.00, which includes includes $14,000 in capital improvements for the office/changing facility, upgrade money for the roads, and $6,000 for snow removal .
The new Water Utility Budget was set at $41,550.

A preliminary design for the new swimming pool bath and changing room – and CMA office – was shown to the members, and a number of ideas were discussed on décor, location and equipment in the facility. Slightly more than half the floor space in the new building will be occupied by the CMA office. The bathrooms have been needed for some time, since swimmers currently have to walk all the way to the barn.

The members present were told of the new water rate, submitted for approval after one year of operations with the new water system. The new water rate is $17 per thousand gallons, and $2 per thousand gallons for sewer. A second rate reduction will be filed in one year, after 12 more months of operations. Treasurer Paul Kagan explained that the old rates were set at $23 per thousand gallons of water because the new water system was completely self-financed for entire capital cost, and was fully paid off in five years.
The CMA assessment for the new year will be $600 per house and $300 per lot.

HAVE YOU RETURNED YOUR BALLOT ON THE PROPOSED CHANGES TO THE COOLFONT COVENANTS? WHILE THERE IS NO TIME LIMIT ON VOTING, PLEASE LET YOUR VIEWS BE KNOWN AS SOON AS POSSIBLE! THANKS!

Annual Meeting Dinner: Kickoff to New CMA Year

More than 90 people gathered in CMA's beautiful chestnut wood barn in the evening following the Annual Meeting for the special catered dinner event.

Event chair Elmer Broxson organized an outstanding menu, with roast beef, chicken and fish entrees, fresh vegetables, and delicious desserts.

One of the highlights of the evening was the slide show and talk by Carroll Yingling and Dick Lehman. The pair celebrated their 70th birthdays by walking 500 miles across Spain, following El Camino, the ancient route of pilgrims from the French town of St. Jean Pied de Port to the cathedral at Santiago de Compostela.

Carroll and Dick averaged 15-20 miles per day, outpacing younger walkers at times, and crossing hundreds of rivers and streams along the way. The trip took them 33 days to complete. A fascinating journey and a great story for our annual meeting dinner!

Social and Communications Committee

The Coolfont Mountainside Association (CMA) Social/Communications Committee will continue the fine tradition of bringing neighbors together in the true spirit of camaraderie established by its previous Committee Chair, Rosemary Bigelow. Much of this reporting period was spent with Rosemary briefing the new Chair, Joan Hash and providing her with information on specific functions of the Committee.

Committee members are Joan Bradfield who is responsible for keeping our telephone/email tree up and running, Alice Minnamon who handles Newcomer activities, Jackson Bain who is our newsletter editor, Rosemary Bigelow who will continue in a supportive role and our new CMA Webmaster, Bob Borchers.

We are in the process of working with the Board to solidify a meeting schedule so we can proceed to finalize our potluck hosts/volunteers.

Annual Meeting, Continued:

Outgoing President Frank Rutherford talked of significant improvements in the Association over the past two years, and he thanked a large team of volunteers and elected board members for making those improvements a reality. He gave deep thanks to Treasurer Paul Kagan for his leadership in organizing CMA finances into two distinct entities – for the Association and for the Water/Sewer Utility. That task had to be completed over the year so that a real measurement of costs and income could be made for our new rate filing before the West Virginia Public Service Commission.

DACC Chairman Richard Kaufman was also thanked for his work in bringing new ideas and order to the task of architectural and environmental oversight in the community. His major accomplishment was making the DACC rules more easily understood and applied, thus reducing confusion and conflict.

Frank also thanked the tireless efforts of Water Operator Elmer Broxson, who has directed the effort to keep the quality of CMA water so high over many years. Special thanks were also extended to CMA Operations Manager John Hobday, who helped build and supervise the construction of much of CMA's current infrastructure, and who maintains it in such excellent condition today.

THE PRESIDENT'S CORNER:



Although I have been on the board of directors for the past 2 years, I did not expect to be named president the at the July annual meeting and for a brief moment thought to myself, "what do I do now?" But I quickly regained my bearings, reassured by the knowledge that some of my predecessors felt the same way when they were named and that I would get lots of help from my fellow board members and from the community. In fact, a good number of people have already volunteered to serve on committees and assist in other ways. For my own part, I am committed to preserving the natural beauty that brought us to the mountainside and I look forward to working with everyone interested in the affairs of the association.

At the first monthly board meeting following the annual meeting the board began working on the issues that will occupy us for the coming months. Among our top priorities, in no particular order, are: *(continued on page 5)*

For the September 30th meeting, Sandy and Jackson Bain graciously agreed to host the potluck in the Barn. We have an offer from the Pearson's to host a potluck also. Any other members, who would like to volunteer, please let one of the Committee members know.

We are very excited about our website. Ideas such as posting our newsletter, member bulletin board/chat, phone list, classified ads, Board minutes, bylaws, DACC rules, etc. are being considered. Policy regarding what members prefer be posted and which entries need password protection will need to be established by the Board. There is a placeholder site up at **http://geocities.com/coolfont_mountainside**. Please send Bob your ideas for future website development!

Joan Hash, Chair



MEET OUR NEIGHBORS

A quarterly feature of the CMA newsletter, "Meet Our Neighbors" encourages all CMA members to write a brief article about themselves, and share your observations and experiences with everyone!

JOAN and BERT HASH, F-4, "Serenity "

My husband Bert and I live in Ellicott City, Maryland and have been married for 30 years. We purchased our vacation home at Coolfont in July of 1994. Earlier, I had been exploring spa vacations going to spas in Texas, Florida and New York before discovering that right in my own back yard was the "cozy" and very reasonable spa at Coolfont. Although I had heard of Coolfont before, I thought of it only as a conference center where businesses went on retreat. What a wonderful surprise it was to find that it was much more. I took the week long spa package in January of 1993 and fell in love. I later returned with my husband for a stay in the chalet "Forget Me Not". It was at that time that I told him that I had to have a piece of the mountain!
At first, we put a bid in on a double lot hoping to build our own chalet. That offer was not taken but we were able to purchase the "Hale House" at F-4 which was up for sale. We finally had our mountain retreat. We named our home "Serenity" because this was to be the place where we would come to get away from the hustle and stress of our jobs.
We have enjoyed our times on the mountainside and the numerous nice people we have met. We have also been able to "shut the world out" when we arrive. We love our home and can't EVER imagine selling it.
I work for the U.S. government and Bert has always worked in the financial industry. We both treasure our privacy and try to totally separate ourselves from reality whenever we come to Coolfont . We feel welcomed by our Coolfont neighbors and have only fond memories of all our visits here.
If I were to describe myself, I would say that I am "funloving by nature with a serious streak". My husband, Bert is much more serious which gives the proper balance to our marriage. I believe that being able to laugh is a gift. We have shared some humorous moments with our Coolfont neighbors at potluck suppers. We enjoy being a part of the CMA community. The simplicity of the mountain is truly a blessing and we hope it can always stay that way. This is what makes life here special !!!!!!

Joan Hash (with Bert)
F-4 "Serenity"



HOUSES AND LOTS FOR SALE AT COOLFONT

(As of October 1, 2000)

SNYDER, BAILEY & ASSOCIATES
Martha Work Ashelman, Agent
Houses:
"Wings" G-5, 3 bdrm, 2 bath $134,500.00
"Timbers" A-3 3 bdr, 1 bath $ 84,950.00
"Aslan's Reach" D-7 6 bdrm, 4 bath (under contract)

Lots:
H-1 $39,000
H-5 $33,000
K-1 & K-2 $78,000 K-1 $42,000 - K-2: $38,000
K-12 $37,500
L- 6 $39,000 SOLD
Q -7 $42,000
S-6 $63,000

KESECKER REALTY

Lot A-2 $29,000

COOLFONT REALTY
Charles Stuart, Agent
Houses:
"Shalom" Lot K-15 5 bdrms, 3 baths $219,900
"Monte Bello" Q-9 3 bdrm 2 1/2 baths $195,500

Lots:
E-3 $34,000
C-3 $30,000
S-6 $68,950
T-Section Lots *(subject to CMA approval of infrastructure)*
T-1 $69,000
T-2 $69,000
T-3 $85,000
T-6 $85,000
T-7 $89,000

FOR SALE BY OWNER:
"Bears Den" K-5 Under Contract

COOLFONT MOUNTAINSIDE ASSOCIATION WATER AMONG THE BEST IN THE UNITED STATES!

So, you always knew the water produced by our Coolfont Mountainside Association system was good, but did you know that CMA's water - right out of the tap - was one of five finalists in the Great American Taste Test sponsored by the National Rural Water Association? The Taste Test was conducted in May, 2000 during the NRWA's Water Rally 2000 in New York City.

Coolfont Mountainside Asssociation's water qualified for the national competition by being selected as co-winner of West Virginia Rural Water Association's 1999 Taste Test, held last September. This water comes from CMA's South well and serves CMA mountainside homes after being pumped up to the Lee Weinberger Reservoir.

The winner of the National Taste Test was the Independence Village Housing Association of Montville, CT. The other national finalists included: Butternut Water Utility in Butternut, WI; Tuppers Plain Chester Water District in Reedsville, OH; and the City of St. Anthony, St. Anthony, ID;

John Hobday, CMA's Operations Manager, and Elmer Broxson, our CMA Licensed Operator, deserve a big round of applause for providing us all with water that ranks among the nation's BEST!

WELCOME TO OUR NEW MOUNTAINSIDE NEIGHBORS!

You may have already met many of our new neighbors listed here, who have come to the mountainside since the Fall of last year. Please add these names to your CMA Directory!

House B-5, Lot B-4 Brian & Jeri Rubin,11622 Yeatman Terrace, Silver Spring, MD 20902

House F-1 Gary & Norma Jean Weightman, P.O. Box 25, La Plata, MD 20646

House K-3 Florence Bender, 2828 Connecticut Avenue, Washington, DC 20008

House K-6 Gordon & Mary Kay Cloney, 10902 Wilder Point Lane, Reston, VA 20191

House K-16 Joseph & Cynthia Van Meter, 1000 Kennedy Street, Falls Church, VA 22046

Lot L-6 Robert & Jean Cohen, 3404 Charleson Street, Annandale, VA 22003

House M-4 James D. & Christina K Chiriaco, 530 South Harrison Street, Arlington, VA 22204

House P-5 Carol G. Fyfe, 10906 Ableside Court, Reston, VA 20190

Lot Q-8 William F. Benson & Catherine Y. Hamel, 14911 Meanderingwood Lane, Burtonsville, MD 20866



PRESIDENT"S CORNER, continued:

- Continued upgrading of the water system and a second reduction in the water rates.
- A long term plan for the improvement and maintenance of our roads.
- Construction of the new pool-side bathroom and office facility.
- Transfer to us of the new T-section.
- Creation of a web site for the assocition.

These items, and others, require close attention by the board and the committees that have responsibility for them. Perhaps the most pressing, for now, concerns the T-section. Under an agreement entered into by the Coolfont Mountainside Association (us) with the Coolfont Development Corporation (Sam Ashelman=s company) in 1995, CDC was permitted to develop 8 lots, known as the T-section, adjoining lands owned by the association.

The road and common lands in the section are to be conveyed to the association when the development is completed and the 8 lots in the section are ready to be sold.. Once the conveyance is made, the section will become part of our community and one year from the date of the conveyance we will be responsible for its maintenance. However, we do not have to accept the conveyance if the deed contains inappropriate provisions or if the water lines or other systems have not been installed properly by CDC. Stay tuned.

Meanwhile, the Labor Day weekend was one of those many delightful times on the mountainside. Cool enough for long walks and hikes, warm enough to spend an afternoon at the pool. Even the tennis courts were in use. Sadly for some, happily for others, the dogwood trees are beginning to turn, reminding us that the summer is just about over and the forest will soon take on the colors of the fall season. Those of us who were there did not have to be reminded to enjoy our surroundings.

Richard F. Kaufman

September, 2000

CMA ROADS COMMITTEE:

Lon Dring has been named chair of CMA's roads committee. He and Jim Lancaster are looking for committee members. They'd also like to hear your ideas and concerns regarding our roads. Contact Lon: 301-871-8764; 304-258-4831 (Narnia); *lon@dring.org*,or at 15004 Rocking Spring Drive, Rockville, MD 20853. Lon says: "These 'country roads take us home'--and connect us. Let's keep them in good shape." *(He sings off key, but he's right on target).* **PLEASE NOTE**: If you want to order gravel or tar & chip for your drive, let Lon know. He is negotiating a better price for one large order.

CLIP AND SAVE: CMA BOARD MEETING DATES!

DATE	*Board mtg location*	*Potluck hosts*
OCTOBER 21st	Hash's, F-4	Sophar's, J-1
NOVEMBER 18th	Kaufman's,R-3	TBD
DECEMBER 9th	Bradfield, N-3	TBD
JANUARY 20th	Barrett, K -4	TBD

Restaurant Review:
Lot 12 Public House
Upscale and Tasty!
By Jackson Bain

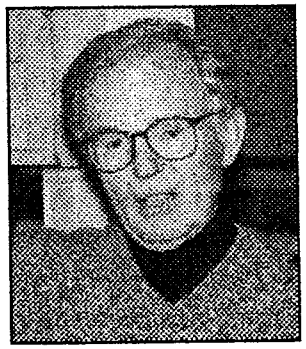
After several months of operation, we felt it was time to give Berkeley Springs' new upscale restaurant – the Lot 12 Public House a try. Many new restaurants need some time to get their feet on the ground, and from our visit, it appears this operation is definitely ready for prime time. Joan Bradfield, Sandy and I went to dinner there on a balmy Friday night on Labor Day Weekend.

Owned and managed by Damian and Betsy Heath (yes, Damian is the son of local artists Jonathan and Jan Heath) the restaurant occupies one of the beautiful older homes up on the hill overlooking the Country Inn and the spa. With both indoor and porch dining (weather permitting) the restaurant has tables for approximately 50 guests at a time, so reservations are recommended almost any night – just to be sure.

The food? You know the seasonings will be fresh as you walk past the huge herb garden on the terraced front lawn. Here are some adjectives – West Virginia Creative: as in mixing Southern red-eye gravy in an Italian dish, and watercress with linguini! Oriental Fun: as in tuna with a spicy wasabi vinaigrette. All of the servings are generous, without threatening your ability to walk out of the place. Desserts were heavenly, *(why do they call great desserts "sinful"?)* and beautifully presented.

Damian's culinary education came at the famed Yellow Brick Bank in Shepherdstown and in North Carolina upscale establishments – and it shows. Give the Lot 12 Public House a try – but be sure to call ahead for a table!
302 Warren Street, Berkeley Springs - (304) 258-6264

In Memoriam: John L. Doppman



Our friend and neighbor John Doppman passed away August 21st at the National Institutes of Health, where he had served for more than 36 years. He is survived by his wife Anne-Marie, and two children - Corinna Oliashirazi and John Christopher Doppman.

John was chief of the diagnostic radiology department at NIH for 26 of those years, and an internationally-lauded researcher and developer of non-surgical radiological techniques. He was a developer of angiography - the now familiar technique of using radio-opaque dye to visualize blood vessels and tumors.

He was the author of 516 articles in scientific journals and 38 textbook chapters. Among his many honors, he recieved the Gold Medal from the Society of Cardiovascular and Interventional Radiology, the Gold Medal of the American Roentgen Ray Society, the Copeland Award from the famed M.D. Anderson Cancer Center and the Public Health Service Distinguished Service Medal, the highest award of the Public Health Service.

Here on the Mountainside, John was a generator of smiles and good ideas. He and Anne-Marie have been regular participants and leaders of official and social CMA gatherings over the years, contributing greatly in time and effort for our commuity. And yet, it is the little things we often remember most fondly. Few neighbors on the South end of CMA will forget the sound of John's whistling echoing up through the trees on those days he enjoyed most - when he was working and playing in his beloved mountainside retreat.

Coolfont Mountainside Association
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